left with a two-pointed valve, termed bicuspid. Both these membranes are attached to the walls of the heart by little muscular cords, and though they appear to be merely finely attenuated threads, they are fashioned, like the valves, with an extraordinary amount of strength and resisting power.

Besides the auricular valves, there are two sets communicating between the ventricles and the arteries. These are termed semilunar valves, and their office is to afford passage from the ventricles to the arteries; the right ventricle forcing the blood into the pulmonary artery, and from thence through the lungs, and the left ventricle by the great aorta throughout the whole body.

In order to gain a correct idea of the course in which the tidal currents of the blood are projected, it is necessary to have a starting-point; and this we shall find by commencing to trace the circuit from the left ventricle. Remember always that the blood does not flow in regular channels through the heart, but that it is propelled by a strong impulse through each valve into its separate cavity. In the left ventricle we find the blood in that bright scarlet condition peculiar to the arterial flow. If we should pierce a vein in any part of the living structure, we would observe a moderate but by no means impulsive flow of the contained fluid; but if we should sever an artery, a violent upward rush of the blood would testify to the momentum with which the current had been impelled. This impulse is originated by the muscular contraction peculiar to the left ventricular cavity, which forces the blood with im-